



Handout 6.4: Neighborhood Map and Price Comparison

Name: _____ Date: _____ Period: _____

Everything in this handout is made up for class. The neighborhood is not a real place. The prices are written to look like a real Long Island supermarket and a real corner store. Nobody is being described here.

Part 1. The two words

Food insecurity means _____



Food desert means _____

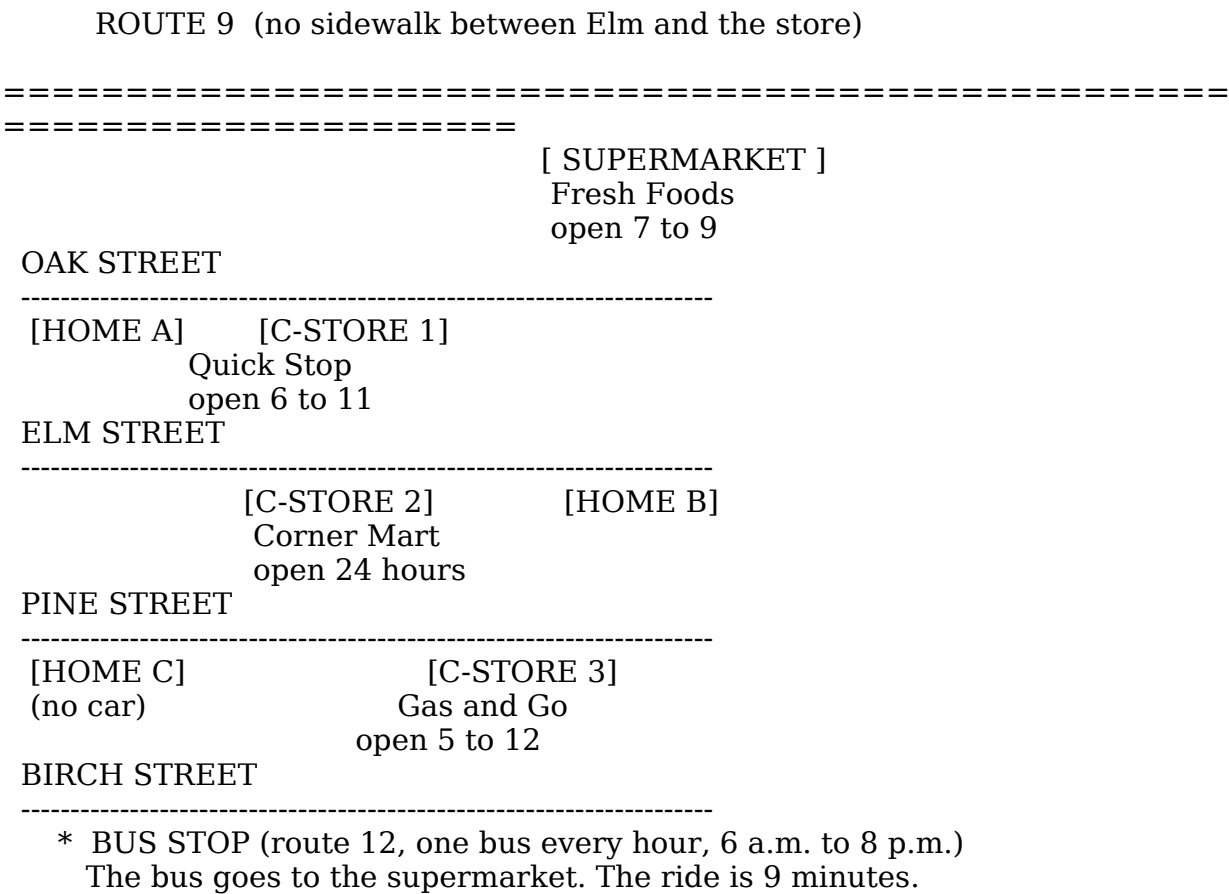
The four things that create a food desert

Cause	One example
Distance	
Transportation	
Price	
Selection (what the store actually stocks)	

Part 2. The neighborhood

Maple Park. About 4,000 people live in the twelve blocks below. There is one full supermarket, three convenience stores, one bus line, and no sidewalk on Route 9 between Elm and the supermarket.

Scale: 1 inch on this map = 0.4 miles. One block = about 0.1 miles.





Highlight the walking route from Home C to the supermarket. How many blocks is it?

Which home has the hardest trip to the supermarket? _____

Name two reasons: _____



What would make it easier? Name one change to the neighborhood, not to the family.





Part 3. Twenty dollars, two stores

You are shopping for one dinner for a family of four. You have \$20. Build a cart at each store.

Fresh Foods Supermarket (1.4 miles from Home C)

Item	Size	Price	Check if you buy it	Cost
Chicken thighs	2 lb pack	\$4.98		
Ground turkey	1 lb	\$4.49		
Dry black beans	1 lb bag	\$1.49		
Canned black beans	15 oz	\$0.99		
Rice	2 lb bag	\$2.29		
Pasta	1 lb box	\$1.29		
Pasta sauce	24 oz jar	\$2.49		
Potatoes	5 lb bag	\$3.99		
Onions	3 lb bag	\$2.99		
Carrots	2 lb bag	\$1.99		
Broccoli	1 head	\$1.99		
Frozen mixed vegetables	12 oz	\$1.29		
Bananas	1 lb (about 3)	\$0.69		
Apples	3 lb bag	\$3.99		
Milk	1 gallon	\$3.99		
Eggs	1 dozen	\$3.49		
Shredded cheese	8 oz	\$2.99		
Bread	1 loaf	\$2.49		
Tortillas	10 count	\$2.49		

Supermarket cart total: \$_____

What is the dinner? _____



Does it feed four? **yes / no**

Corner Mart (0.2 miles from Home C, open 24 hours)

Item	Size	Price	Check if you buy it	Cost
Canned black beans	15 oz	\$1.89		
Rice	14 oz box	\$2.79		
Pasta	1 lb box	\$2.49		
Pasta sauce	16 oz jar	\$3.49		
Frozen pizza	1	\$6.99		
Canned soup	10.5 oz	\$2.29		
Canned corn	15 oz	\$1.79		
White bread	1 loaf	\$3.49		
Milk	1 quart	\$2.79		
Eggs	6 count	\$3.29		
Sliced cheese	6 slices	\$2.99		
Hot dogs	8 count	\$4.49		
Ramen noodle packs	3 packs	\$1.50		
Chips	1 large bag	\$4.29		
Soda	2 liter	\$3.19		
Candy bar	1	\$2.29		
Fresh vegetables		not sold here		
Fresh fruit		1 banana, \$0.99		
Fresh meat		not sold here		

Corner Mart cart total: \$ _____

What is the dinner? _____

Does it feed four? **yes / no**

The comparison

The difference in dollars: the supermarket cart bought _____ pounds of food for \$20 and the Corner Mart cart bought _____ pounds for \$20.

The difference in food: in one sentence, what does the supermarket family eat that the Corner Mart family does not?



The item that was not available at all at Corner Mart: _____

Part 4. Five responses. Pick two.

Response	What it is	Rank 1 to 5
Food pantry	A place, often run by a church, a school, or a nonprofit, that gives out groceries for free. Some are open one day a week	
SNAP and WIC	Federal programs. SNAP puts money on a card that can be used for groceries at approved stores. WIC provides specific foods for pregnant women, new mothers, infants, and young children. Both are run through the state	
Community garden	A shared plot where neighbors grow food. Some are run by a town, some by a school, some by a neighborhood group	
Mobile market	A truck or van that parks in a neighborhood on a schedule and sells fresh produce at low prices	
School meals	Breakfast and lunch served at school. In many New York schools every student eats at no charge	

My top two, with evidence from the map or the price lists:

Choice 1: _____ Evidence: _____

Choice 2: _____ Evidence: _____

Exit card

A food desert is _____, and the thing that would help the most is _____ because _____.

Teacher key

Part 1: Food insecurity is not having reliable access to enough affordable food. A food desert is a neighborhood where reaching a full grocery store is hard because of distance, transportation, or both. Accept student wording that includes distance or transportation for the second one. Do not accept “a place with no food,” which is the most common wrong answer and the reason the do now asks for the guess first.

Part 2 distances, measured from the map as drawn: Home A to the supermarket, about 1.1 miles; Home B, about 0.7 miles; Home C, about 1.4 miles. Nearest convenience store: Home A to Quick Stop about 0.3 miles, Home B to Corner Mart about 0.4 miles, Home C to Corner Mart about 0.2 miles.

Home C has the hardest trip. Reasons: it is the farthest, the household has no car, the bus runs once an hour so a round trip eats most of an afternoon, there is no sidewalk on part of the route, and frozen or refrigerated food will not survive the wait at the stop.

What would make it easier, good answers: a bus every twenty minutes, a stop closer to the supermarket door, a sidewalk on Route 9, a mobile market on Pine Street, a grocery delivery that accepts SNAP, a small grocery in the empty storefront. Reject “the family should get a car,” and use it to make the point that the causes are about the neighborhood, not the household.

Part 3, a strong supermarket cart under \$20: chicken thighs \$4.98, rice \$2.29, carrots \$1.99, broccoli \$1.99, potatoes \$3.99, bananas \$0.69, eggs \$3.49 equals \$19.42, which is a real dinner with leftovers and breakfast the next day. Many combinations work.

Part 3, a Corner Mart cart under \$20: pasta \$2.49, pasta sauce \$3.49, canned corn \$1.79, sliced cheese \$2.99, white bread \$3.49, milk quart \$2.79 equals \$17.04. It feeds four once, with no vegetables beyond a can of corn and no fresh anything.

The item not available at all: fresh vegetables and fresh meat. Accept either.

The difference: the supermarket cart buys roughly two to three times the food weight and includes fresh produce and a real protein. That is the number and the sentence to hold on to.

Part 4: there is no single right pair. Full credit for any two picks defended with evidence from the map or the price lists. The strongest defenses in this neighborhood usually name the mobile market (because distance and transportation are the binding problems and a mobile market moves the store to the people) and school meals (because they reach children every weekday with no trip required). A pantry helps but is open one day a week. SNAP helps with price but not with distance. A garden helps in summer only. Any of those, argued on the evidence, earns full credit.

Handling note: read Part 3 and the exit cards before handing anything back. If a student answer reveals something about their own household, that is a private conversation with the counselor’s help, not a comment in the margin. See the three rules at the top of Lesson 6.4.



Scoring: daily work, complete, partial, or missing. Look for six distances measured with the scale, both carts totaled at or under \$20, and two responses each with one piece of evidence.